Official Community Plan

Phase 4

Engagement Summary
January 2026

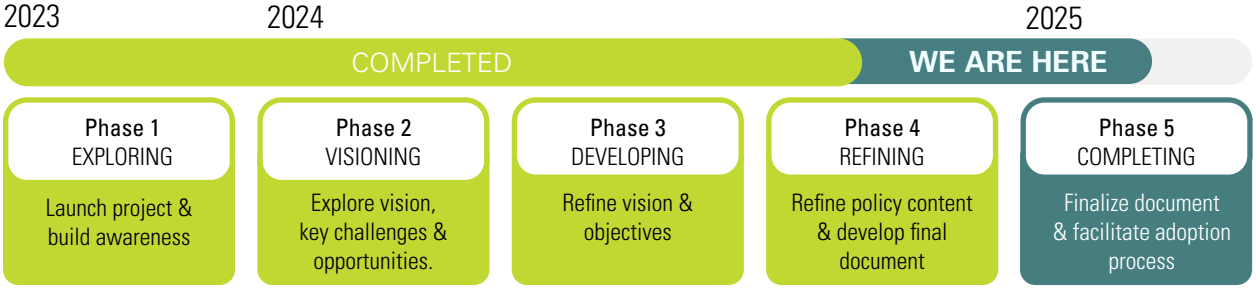
CITY OF SURREY

Where We Are

Introduction

The Official Community Plan (OCP) is one of Surrey's most important policy documents, providing a long-term framework for how the city will evolve over time.

The OCP update process began in 2023 and has involved multiple phases of research, analysis, and public input. The OCP update is now in its final stage, where key components of the draft plan, including draft land use designations and policies have been shared for feedback.



What We Did

Phase 4: Refining

Engagement for Phase 4 began in October 2025 and focused on sharing the refined draft policies and land use designations that will guide Surrey's future growth. During this phase, the key components of the OCP were framed around its vision and values to help the community understand the purpose of the plan. Engagement in Phase 4 included a community survey and an OCP informative video.

By The Numbers...

There are approximately 610,000 residents within Surrey. Here's a breakdown of people that were engaged or informed in the Phase 4.

Approximately,

1,455 **Engaged Residents**

An engaged resident is defined as an individual or group that has contributed to the project website, and completed the survey.

Residents were engaged through:

1,455 Surveys Completed & Questions Asked

Approximately,

126,830+ **Informed Residents**

An informed resident is defined as an individual or group that has made at least one single visit to the project website, or interacted with the project through social media.

Residents were informed through:

88,670+ Content Views

35,930+ eNews Interactions

2,230 Social Media Interactions*
*clicks, reactions, comments, and shares

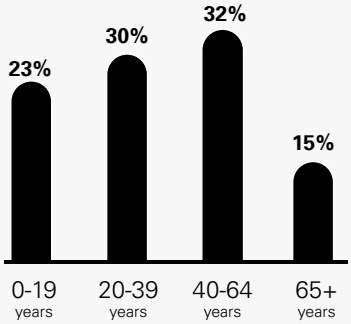
Who We Reached

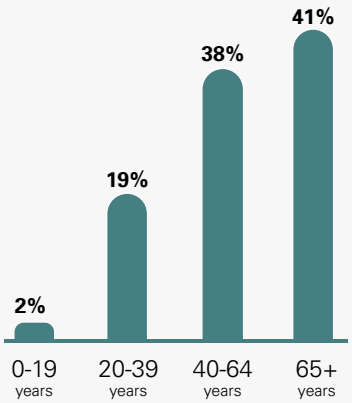
Our goal is to ensure we hear from a balanced and diverse range of residents in Surrey. Below is a profile of the City of Surrey compared with a profile of who we reached in this survey.

Community Profile

Survey Respondents

Age





Tenure

30% Rent **70%** Own

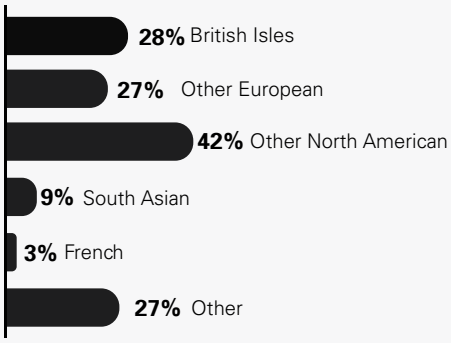
14% Rent **86%** Own

Income

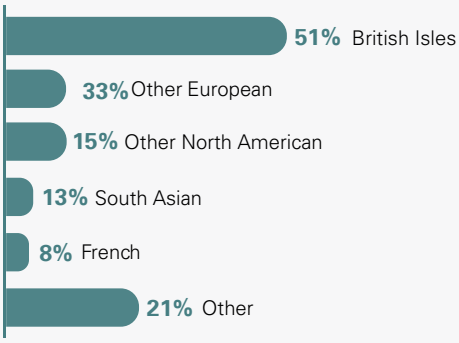
Less than $30,000	**9%**
$30,000 to less than $59,999	**18%**
$60,000 to less than $99,999	**25%**
$100,000 to less than $149,999	**23%**
$150,000 or more	**26%**

Less than $30,000	**5%**
$30,000 to less than $59,999	**22%**
$60,000 to less than $99,999	**27%**
$100,000 to less than $149,999	**23%**
$150,000 or more	**23%**

Ethnicity



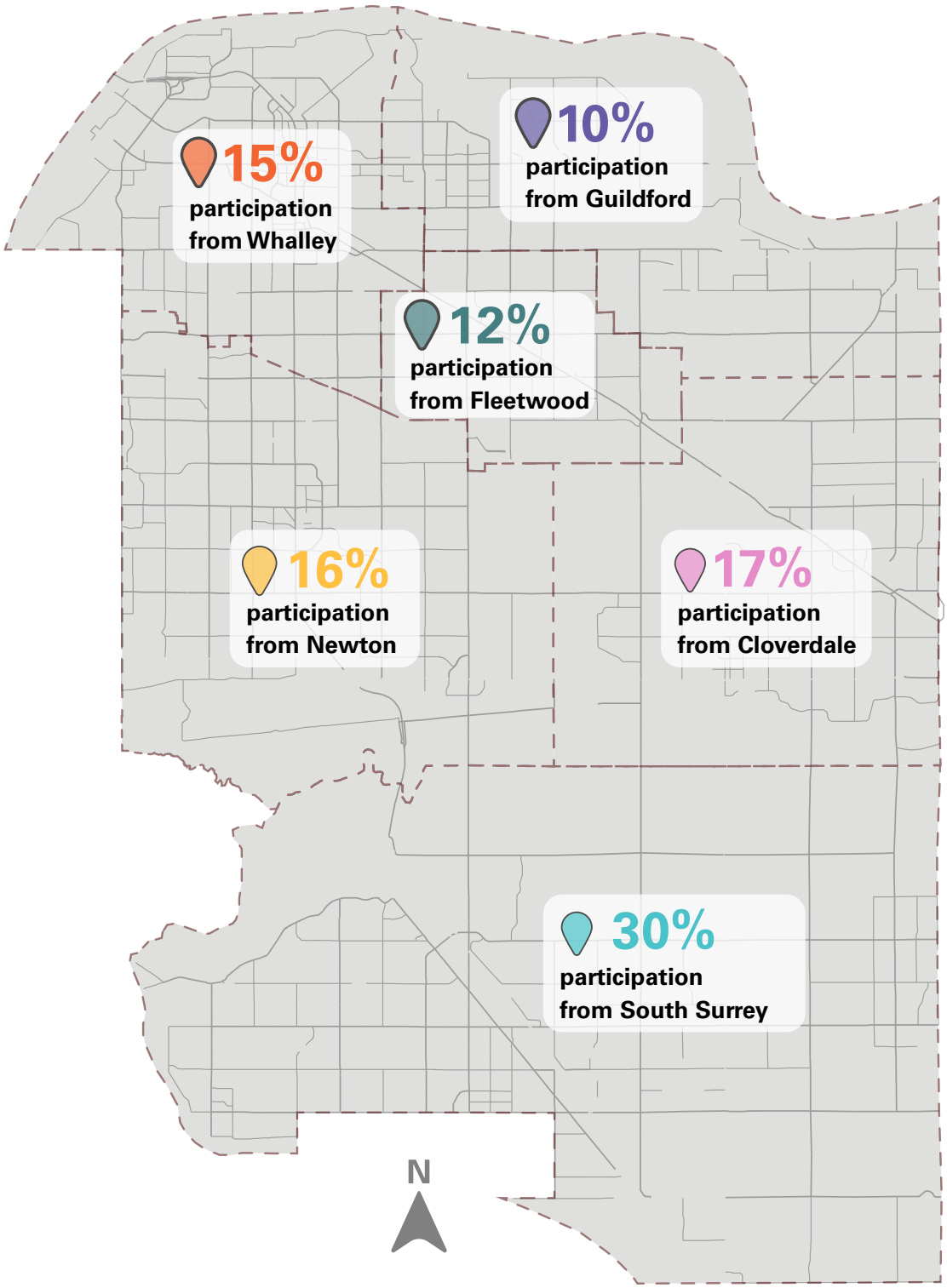
*Respondents were able to select multiple options



*Respondents were able to select multiple options

Engagement Participation

The majority of survey participants were from Surrey, accounting for 98% of responses. The remaining 2% were from other municipalities, including Vancouver, Langley, Delta, Burnaby, and others. The map below illustrates the distribution of respondents across Surrey's communities.



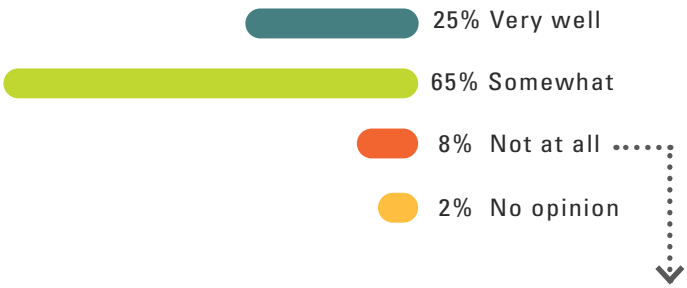
What We Heard

Understanding the OCP

The Official Community Plan (OCP) is an overarching City of Surrey document that guides Surrey's growth and development over the next 30 years. The OCP guides and manages Surrey's growth by setting a city-wide framework of land use designations, goals, and policies that support the vision of a **thriving, green, and inclusive city for one million people.**

1. We asked participants how well do they understand the role of the OCP in Surrey's growth and development. (1,455 responses)

90%
Said they understand

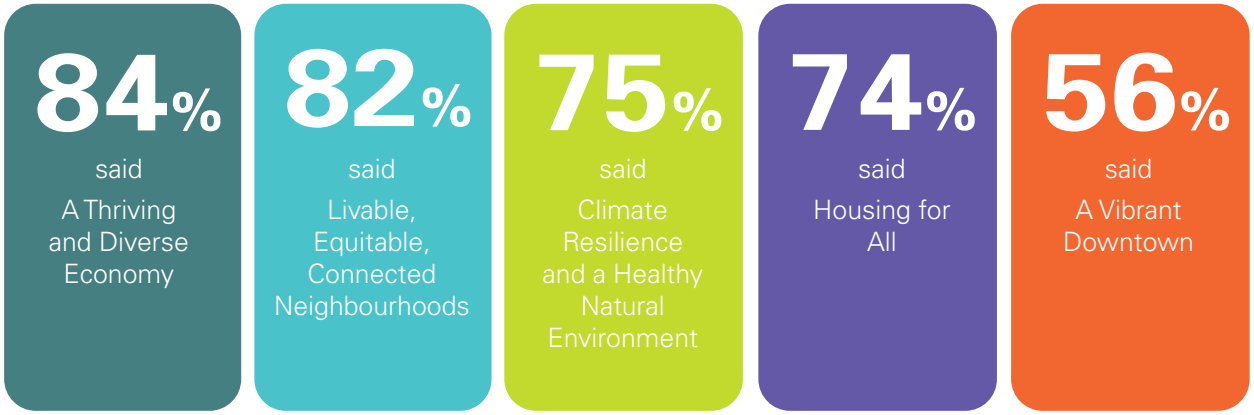


For those who said, "not at all", we asked what makes them feel this way. (57 responses)

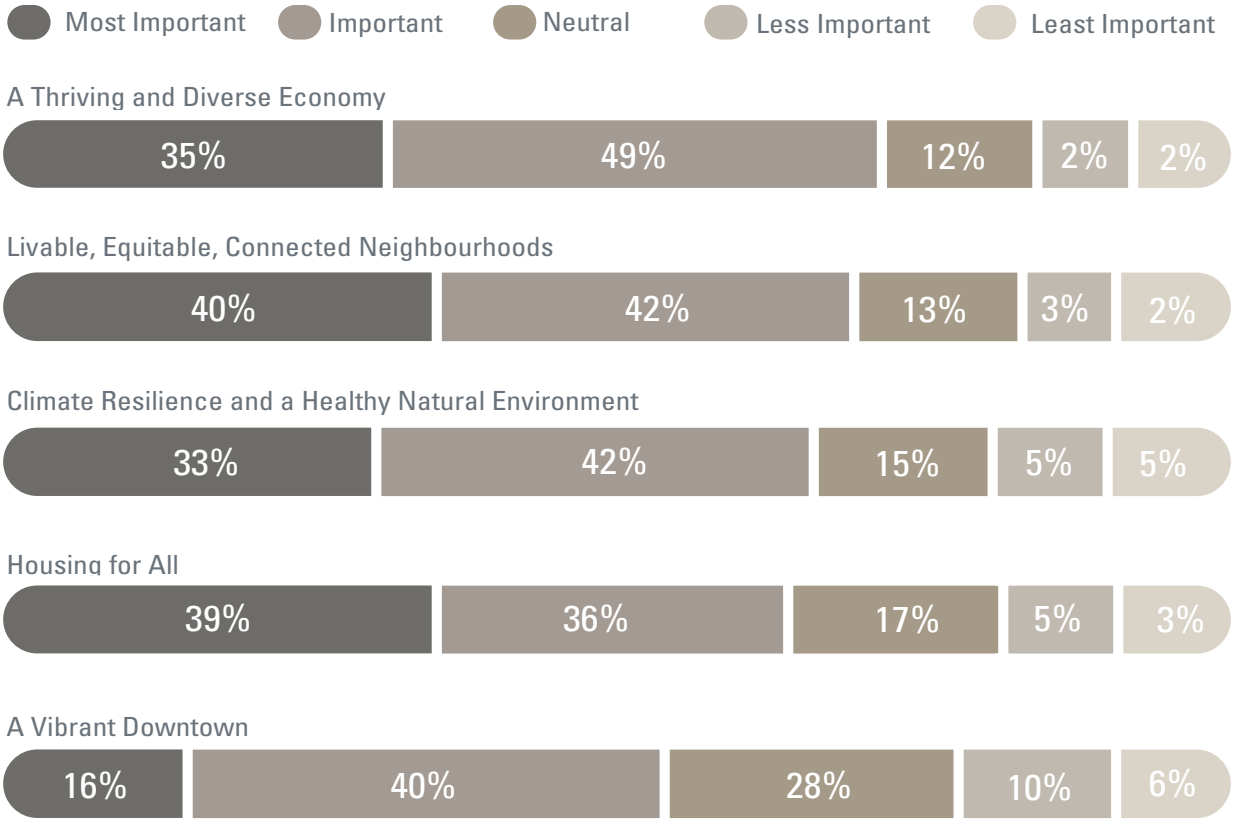
Key themes that emerged:

- Unfamiliarity with OCP.
- Being a relatively new Surrey resident.

2. We asked participants what are the most important city priorities to make progress on in the next five years. (1,455 respondents)



Responses included the following breakdown:



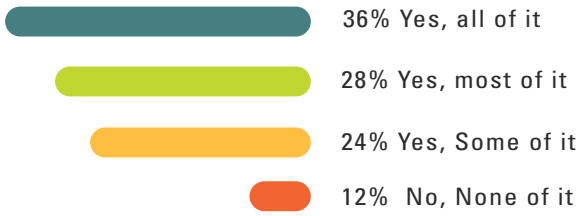
Draft Land Use Summary

A draft land use summary was shared, which included the draft land use designations descriptions and a land use map of Surrey. Together, they illustrate how the City may redevelop over time by stating a range of appropriate uses and building types.

3a. We asked participants if they read the draft OCP Land Use Summary. (1,455 respondents)

88%

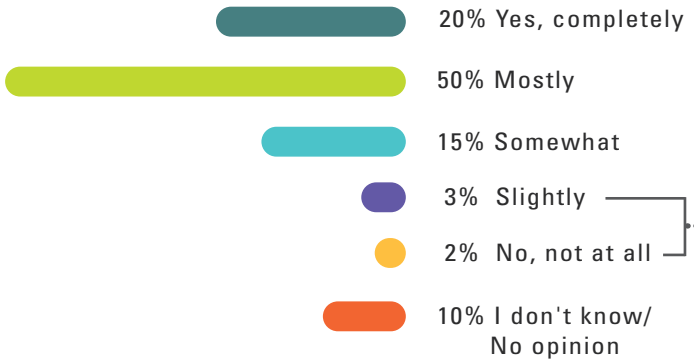
Said they read the draft land use summary



3b. We asked participants if they understand how the draft land use summary will help with the growth and development throughout the city. (1,455 respondents)

85%

Said they understand



For those who said, "slightly and no, not at all", we asked what makes them feel this way. (78 respondents)

Key themes that emerged:

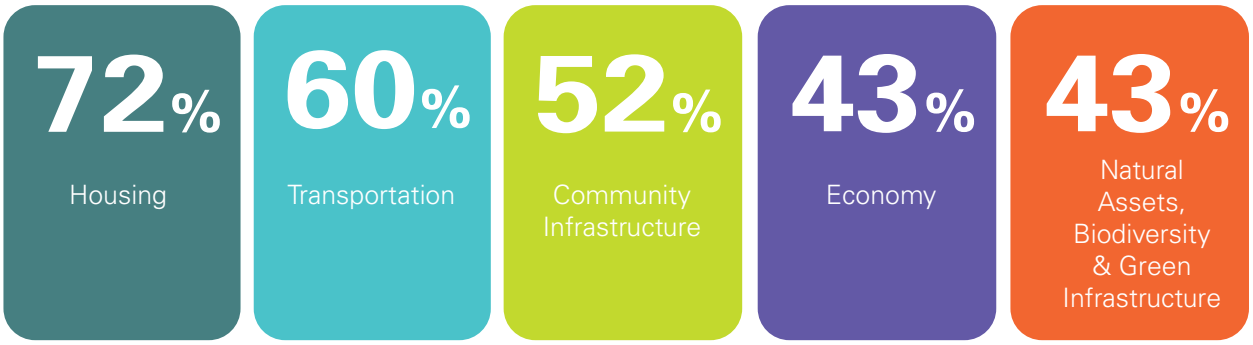
- Suggestion to provide more detailed information.
- Emphasis on infrastructure to meet the pace of growth and development in Surrey.
- Suggestion to provide more information on walkable and transit-friendly areas.
- Emphasis on preserving neighbourhood character while accommodating growth.

Draft Policy Chapter

A draft policy section was shared which included eight policy chapters with goals, objectives, and policy actions. Together, they set priorities and help guide land use decisions.

4a. We asked participants to select the policy chapters they wanted to review. (1,455 respondents)

Top 5 chapters selected included:



4b. We asked participants if the goals, objectives, and policies were clear to them. (1,455 respondents)

For those who said, "no, not clear", we asked what makes them feel this way. (30 respondents)

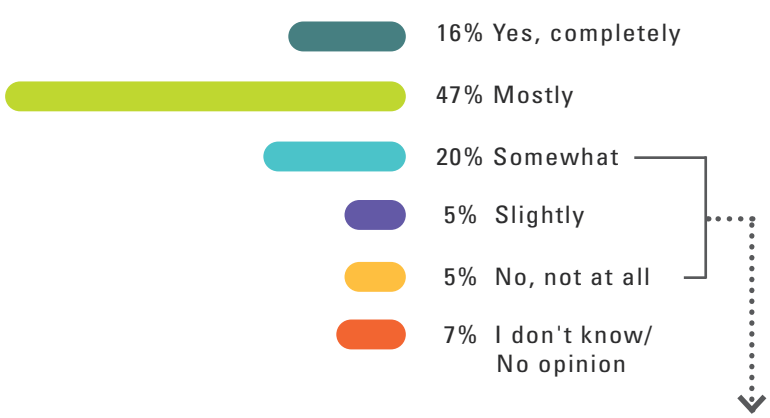
Key themes that emerged:

- Concerns about lack of parking and transit with increasing population.
- Suggestion to provide more emphasis on protecting agricultural lands.
- Suggestion to provide more emphasis on preserving biodiversity.
- Concerns about housing affordability.

5. **We asked participants if the goals, objectives, and policies support the OCP's vision of "A thriving, green, inclusive city for 1 million people." (1,455 respondents)**

63%

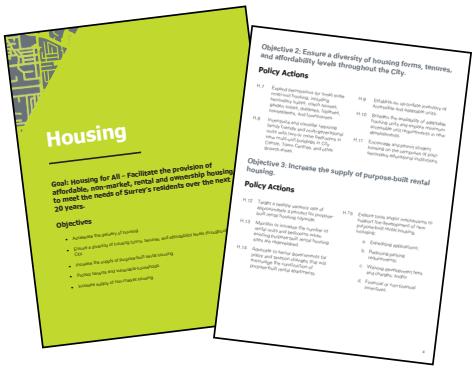
Said they agree



For those who "somewhat, slightly, no - not at all", we asked what makes them feel this way. (30 respondents)

Key themes that emerged:

- Concerns about impacts of increasing density on green space.
- Concerns about lack of parking, traffic, and congestion.
- Concerns about climate action and lack of environmental protection.
- Suggestions to measure the progress by adding defined targets.



The policy section has eight chapters, covering topics like housing, economy, and transportation. Detailed goals, objectives and policy actions were shared for each chapter for feedback.

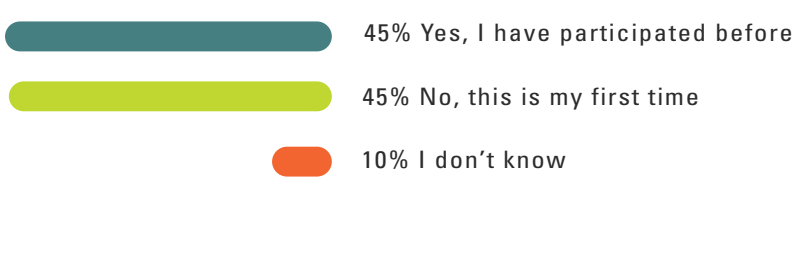
Engagement Learnings

The OCP Update was one of the most comprehensive engagement processes the City has undertaken, spanning across two years. As we move forward, the Official Community Plan (OCP) will be updated and reviewed every five years, with ongoing opportunities for public input. We sought feedback on the current OCP engagement process to understand what worked well and identify ways to improve participation and inclusion in future updates.

6. We asked participants if they engaged or participated in previous OCP Phases. (1,455 respondents)

45%

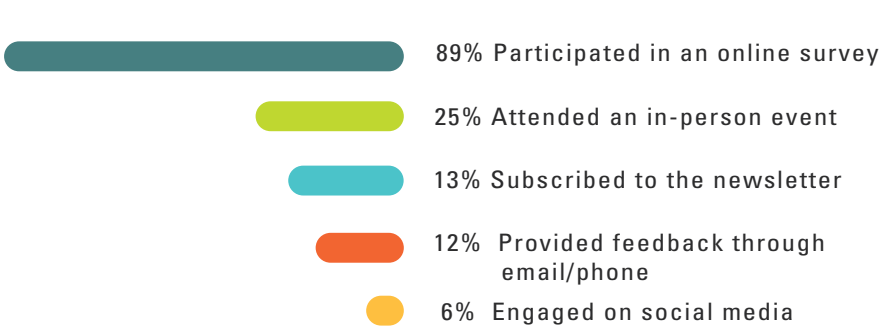
Said yes



6a. For those who said "yes", we asked how they participated in OCP engagement in the past. (405 respondents)

89%

Participated in an online survey

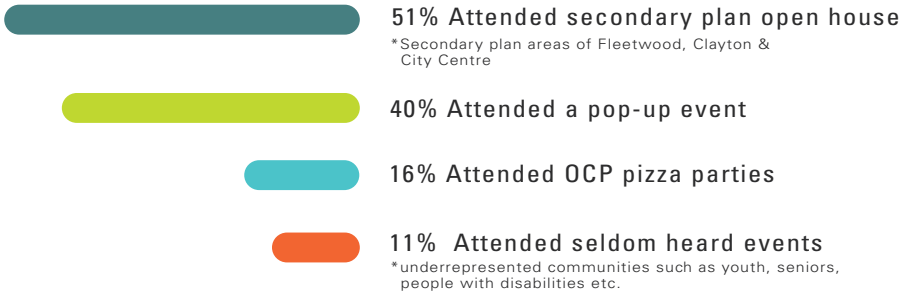


*Respondents were able to select multiple options

6b. For those who said "attended an in-person event", we asked which event did they participate in. (102 respondents)

51%

Participated in secondary plan open house

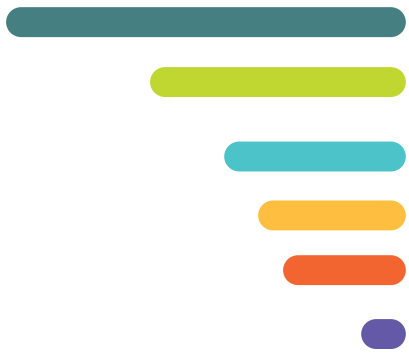


*Respondents were able to select multiple options

7. **We asked participants how would they like to engage on the OCP in the future. (1,455 respondents)**

77%

Said through online surveys



*Respondents were able to select multiple options

Next Steps

The feedback collected during Phase 4 will help shape the draft OCP policies and draft land use designations, and the plan will be finalized for Council approval in early 2026.

Learn More

- Visit surrey.ca/planning for general information on the Official Community Plan.